Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦5

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣10

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 9 6 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ A Q J 6 ♣ K 5	
♠ 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ K 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ 9 7 2		♠ 10 7 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 8 6 3
	♠ K Q 8 5 ♥ J 6 3 ♦ 8 7 ♣ A Q J 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♣[4]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6♠ by North
Lead: ♦5

When SOUTH gives immediate ♠ support, NORTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so NORTH bids 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which NORTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

NORTH bids 6♠ since SOUTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 5 3
♥ 6 5
♦ A 7 5
♣ J 8 6 5

♠ K Q J
♥ A K 10
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ —

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 3 2
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A 10 9 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦4

WEST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but EAST gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

EAST then bids 3♠, showing first round control. WEST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and EAST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

WEST bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ —

♠ Q J 6
♥ 9 2
♦ J 5
♣ K 8 7 5 4 2



♠ 10 9 7 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 10 4 2
♣ A Q 10 3

♠ K 5
♥ A K 10 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	7♥
All Pass			

7♥ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

SOUTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

NORTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

SOUTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q 10 7 2 ♥ 4 2 ♦ Q J 5 3 2 ♣ 7 4	
♠ K 5 3 ♥ K Q J 10 3 ♦ A ♣ K Q 10 6		♠ — ♥ A 9 7 5 ♦ K 9 8 6 4 ♣ J 9 3 2
	♠ A J 9 8 6 4 ♥ 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ A 8 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣7

WEST figures that if EAST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

EAST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

WEST manages to figure out that EAST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 8 6 4
♥ A K Q
♦ 7
♣ K J 6 3

♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2



♠ Q J
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10 9 4
♣ 10 9 8

♠ K 7 5 3
♥ J 8 7
♦ A 8 6 5
♣ 7 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣10

NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 10 9 4 2
♥ A 7
♦ 10 5 4
♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4



♠ —
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K J 8 6
♥ 5
♦ Q 9 7 6 3
♣ 10 8 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♥5

EAST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and WEST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that WEST holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!